

## » ISL DIARY

**S**ome matches assume an aura of exceptional competitiveness that keeps fans talking about them for a long time.

Such was the case when Mohun Bagan Super Giant met the Juggernauts (read Odisha FC) in matchweek nine of Indian Super League, a contest that took the form of a gladiatorial duel.

The season started with the two sides meeting in the AFC Cup group league fixtures. The Mariners won the first match (on September 19) 4-0 at the Kalinga Stadium before the Juggernauts visited Salt Lake Stadium to avenge the defeat 5-2 (November 27). The second result saw an end to Mohun Bagan's journey in the continental competition while brightening the possibility of Odisha's qualification to the next stage.

The conflict assumed a bigger form as the two met again in the Indian Super League fixture (on December 6) at the Salt Lake Stadium.

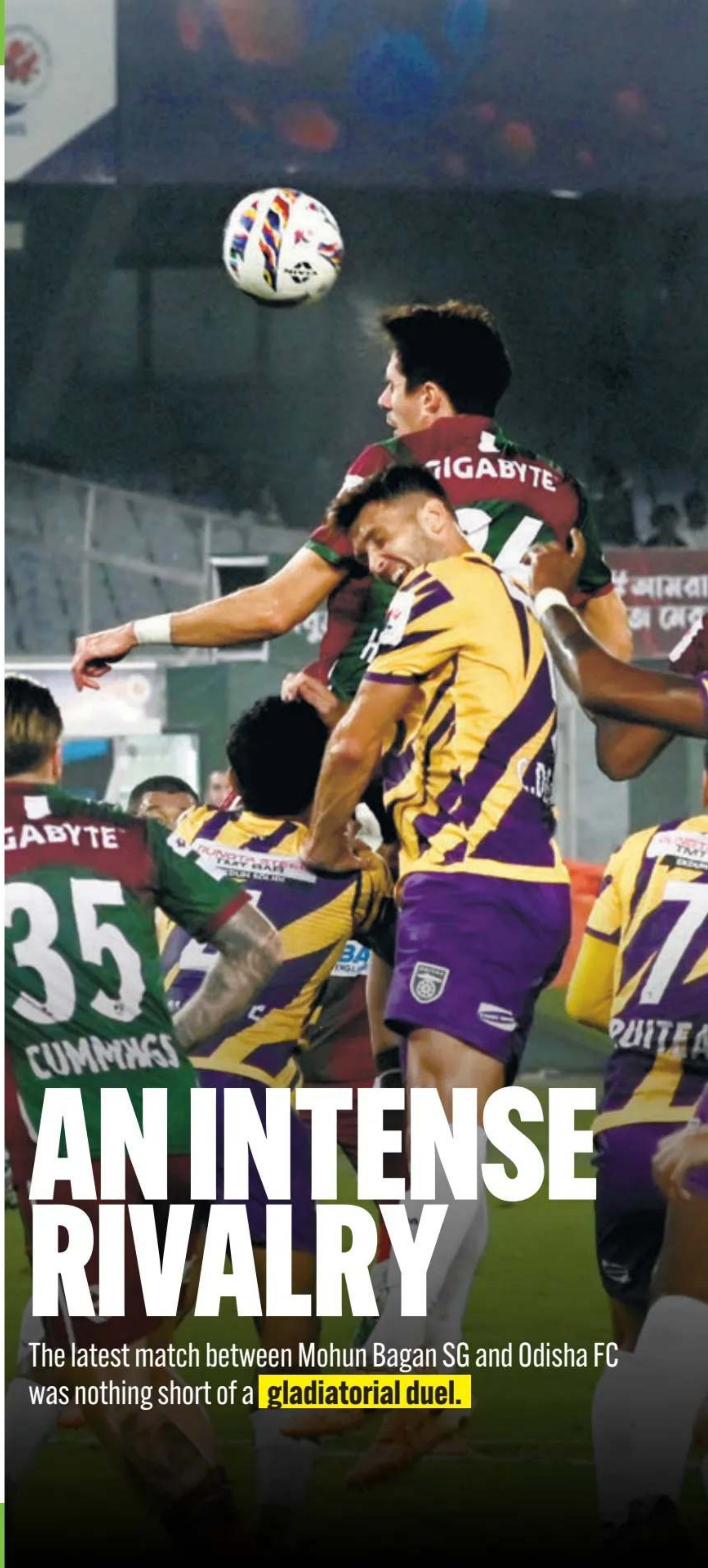
The action on the ground was an intense, venomous battle. Odisha FC enjoyed the first half, leading 2-0 in a scrappy encounter, before Mohun Bagan rallied back to draw level 2-2.

The frayed tempers of that fiery match left three Mohun Bagan players injured and saw the players and the coaching staff get involved in a verbal joust after the match, sometimes giving way to pushing and shoving.

Referee Crystal John finally brought an end to the undesirable post-match incident by flashing red cards to Mohun Bagan's head coach Juan Ferrando and Odisha FC striker Diego Mauricio. Roy Krishna, a former Mohun Bagan player now joining the Odisha FC ranks, also played a big role in the altercation but escaped with a booking.

**Amitabha Das Sharma**

**Brutal encounter:** Odisha FC enjoyed the first half, leading 2-0 in a scrappy encounter, before Mohun Bagan rallied back to draw level 2-2. PTI



# AN INTENSE RIVALRY

The latest match between Mohun Bagan SG and Odisha FC was nothing short of a **gladiatorial duel.**